

# Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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## SUMMARY

Model Risk Management Analyst, AVP candidate with ~7 years across independent model validation, model governance, and quantitative risk analytics. Exercises delegated sign-off authority at Moody's Analytics on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement, and sits on the model governance committee covering methodology review, benchmarking, and model-performance assessment. Statistical, stochastic, and Python-based modelling depth; IFRS 9 transformation delivery at EY. CFA charterholder, dual MSc.

## CORE SKILLS

Independent Model Validation & Review • Model Risk Management & Governance (SR 11-7-aligned) • Validation Documentation & Escalation Management • Model Performance Monitoring & Benchmarking • Statistical Analysis, Stochastic & Monte Carlo Modelling • Stress Testing & Scenario Analysis • Python, R & SQL • IFRS 9 & IFRS 17 Transformation Delivery • Technical Communication to Non-Technical Stakeholders

## EXPERIENCE

### **Moody's Analytics**

#### **Asst. Director - Modelling Services**

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

#### **Independent Model Validation & Review**

- Exercise delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs delivered to multi-asset institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (~\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Operate within a formal model-governance framework - reviewing assumptions, validating economic defensibility, and documenting review outcomes to standards consistent with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 expectations.
- Validated derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, confirming consistency of sensitivities and scenario impacts at portfolio-level aggregates.
- Review aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics feeding downstream ALM and capital processes.

#### **Model Governance & Escalation Management**

- Serve on the model governance committee, contributing to methodology review, documentation and benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Escalate outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility; serve as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, working with product owners and clients' Heads of Risk to drive resolution.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into auditable Python pipelines with embedded logging and validation controls, supporting model-governance requirements on reproducibility and versioning.

#### **Quantitative Modelling, Stress Testing & Reporting**

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenario analysis across multi-year horizons.
- Embedded behavioral cash flow assumptions, prepayment logic, and macro stress overlays aligned with regulatory liquidity expectations.
- Oversee interest-rate and duration analysis under parallel and non-parallel rate shocks for institutional client balance sheets.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and anomaly detection - reducing development cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.
- Prepare analytical summaries translating quantitative output into rate-exposure, scenario-impact, and balance-sheet narratives for senior non-technical stakeholders.

### **Client Service Specialist**

*Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023*

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms on PFaroe DB (risk & ALM analytics) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management), validating model outputs post-deployment.
- Served as technical liaison between client investment teams and product owners, translating requirements into scoped development requests.

### **Ernst & Young (EY)**

#### **Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation**

*Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022*

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with system implementation and financial-reporting frameworks.
- Advised actuarial, finance, IT, and program-management functions on standard adoption; contributed to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes.

### **Ortec Finance Canada**

#### **Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk**

*Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021*

- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators using statistical analysis and Monte Carlo simulation to assess interest-rate risk and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition and near-optimal frontier analysis to test robustness of recommendations.
- Delivered ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds, analyzing funding ratios, duration mismatch, and long-term balance-sheet exposures.
- Presented study findings and methodology assumptions to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients on-site.

## **EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS**

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- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016